

Easy DIY Mealworm Farm Guide

1. Gather Your Supplies

- Plastic tub (~6" deep, like an ice-cream bucket). Mealworms can't climb smooth plastic.
- Wheat bran (2–3" layer) – acts as both bedding and food.
- 500+ starter mealworms or beetles (avoid giant mealworms).
- Vegetable scraps (e.g., carrot or potato peels) for moisture.

2. Set Up Your Farm

- Clean and dry your plastic tub.
- Add a 2–3" layer of wheat bran.
- Place worms/beetles on top and cover with a lid or mesh.

3. Feeding & Hydration

- Add small chunks of veggies weekly (carrot or potato). No free-standing water.
- Use one large potato per big bin or 4" of carrot for a small tub.

4. Maintenance & Rotation

- Remove old veggie scraps every 4–8 days.
- Every 4–6 weeks, transfer adult beetles/pupae to a fresh bin. Leave some behind for continuity.
- Keep up to 4 bins going at a time. When you're ready to start a 5th, dump the oldest (1st) bin into your compost.

5. Environmental Conditions

- Keep in a warm (~65–70°F / 19°C), dark place.
- When well-maintained, there should be no odor.

6. Harvesting the Mealworms

- Move pupae or beetles to a separate 'beetle bin' to maintain the colony.
- Use mealworms for chicken or reptile feed, or composting.